

Mauch Anxious to View Phillies

HOMESTEAD, Fla.—Questions and answers with ex-Miller Gene Mauch, newly-named manager of the Phillies:

Q—What will you do with the Phillies?

A—Watch 'em play for a while. Maybe I can help them improve when I get to know them and they get to know me."

Q—Do you plan any major changes?

A—"None right now. I haven't seen the club play yet."

Q—Do you think the Phillies are a last-place club in the National league?

A—"I don't know. I'm only sorry I didn't get the chance to take spring training with the Phils to learn more about them."

Q—Are you a National leaguer at heart?

A—"Let's say I played most of my major league baseball in the National, only one year with the Red Sox. The National is the league I know best."

Q—Have you always wanted to manage in the majors?

A—"Always. This is my first job in title in the majors,

but I managed for years in my own mind with the managers when I was with the Red Sox, Cubs, Braves, Brooklyn.

Q—What's the Phils' strong point?

A—Pitching—a good staff. It's the type of club I've been managing at Minneapolis the past two years, banking on pitching. We'll have to tighten the defense. And I'd like to know what's the matter with a hitter like outfielder Harry Anderson. I think he can do much better than he's been doing."

Q—Would you like to have any of the Miller players with you at Philadelphia?

A—"Not likely, although I haven't given it a thought."

Q—How about your coaching staff—Andy Cohen, Ken Silvestri, Dick Carter?

A—"I won't know about that until I meet the Phils for the first time in Pittsburgh Saturday. Of course, I know fellows like Curt Simmons, Robin Roberts, Al Dark, Joe Koppe, Ken Walters, John Callison."

Q—Do you expect any trouble with the Phils' "problem-children" pitchers, fellows like Jim Owens and Dick Farrell?

A—"I'm not anticipating any problems. I'm not worried about handling men."

SPORTS



by TOM BRIERE

TESTIMONY